

"I WANT TO PLAY THE ROLE OF BALRAM IN MAHABHARAT."

Vishwanath Pratap Singh after taking over as Prime Minister

RAGHU RAI



V.P. Singh inherited one of the most difficult jobs in the world, running the country with a minority government hanging between the Left and the Right. His reign saw the explosion of the Mandal bomb, the motive behind which was creating a caste matrix that could make his seat unassailable for the next 20 years. He fell from power in 11 months, after bringing to a grinding halt L.K. Advani's Rath Yatra. The subsequent tom-tomming of the secular card couldn't save Mr Clean.

MIRA MASALA

Mira Nair's *Salaam Bombay* won the prestigious Golden Camera award at Cannes and was nominated for an Oscar in the best Foreign Language category. It was the first film to be nominated since *Mother India* in 1957. The film, co-written by her friend Sooni Taraporevala, starred 24 handpicked real street children who were trained at a special workshop before appearing in the film.



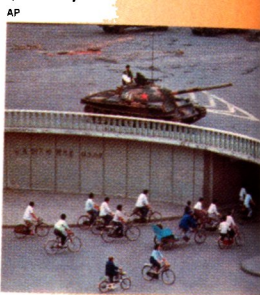
BHAWAN SINGH



Comeback Man

M. Karunanidhi returned to power 13 years after an ignominious exit. In one of the most dramatic victories in India's electoral history, his party DMK won 147 of the 198 seats it contested, making him the chief minister of Tamil Nadu for the third time.

• Hundreds of civilians were shot dead by the Chinese Army in the Tiananmen Square massacre. The army's attempt to crush a democratic uprising in Peking was telecast to the whole world (below).



• The Berlin Wall fell on November 9 as East Germans swarmed across checkpoints to meet their West German compatriots, after weeks of protests against East German authorities.

• Emperor Hirohito of Japan died at the age of 87 after the longest reign in the history of Japan.

\$470

million is the amount Union Carbide agreed to pay India for damages in the 1984 Bhopal gas tragedy in an out-of-court settlement in May. While the personal damage was taken care of, the environmental impact was ignored.

RANASINGHE PREMADASA on the IPKF's involvement in Sri Lanka

"The Indians came on our invitation and helped us. Now they must go and help us by going."